Experiment 13: Building Approval-Based Workflow Automation in a Zoho Creator Application

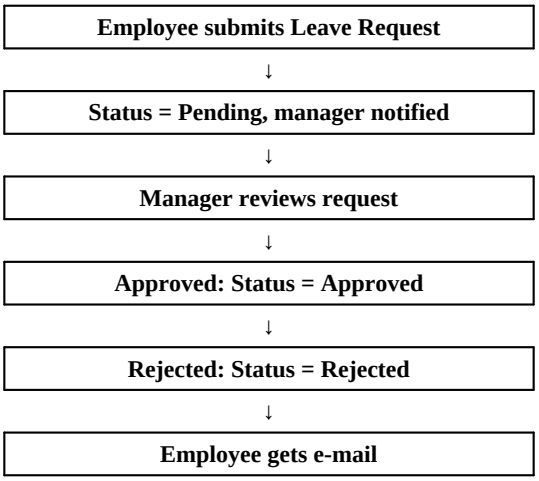
Aim

To build an approval workflow in the Leave Management System so that every leave request is approved or rejected by a manager.

Objective

- Understand workflows and approvals in Zoho Creator.
- Trigger an action when a form is submitted.
- Update the status after approval or rejection.
- Send e-mail notifications automatically.

Workflow Design



(The last two steps after the manager's review are alternative outcomes.)

Procedure

1. Open the application and go to **Workflow** (Workflows > Form Workflow) for the Leave Request form.
2. Create a workflow named **Leave Approval**; trigger: **On Create - On Success** of the form.
3. Add a **Send Mail** action to notify the manager that a request is pending (see script below).
4. Open the form's **Approval** settings (or create an approval workflow) and select the approver, for example the manager's user or a field containing the manager's e-mail.
5. Define the **On Approve** action: set Status = Approved and send a mail to the employee.
6. Define the **On Reject** action: set Status = Rejected and send a mail with the reason.
7. Save, then submit a test leave request, approve one request and reject another, and check the Status field and mails.

Sample Deluge Script

On form submit (notify manager):

```
input.Status = "Pending";
sendmail
[
    from: zoho.adminuserid
    to: "manager@example.com"
    subject: "Leave approval needed: " + input.Employee_Name
    message: "Leave type: " + input.Leave_Type + " from " +
             input.From_Date + " to " + input.To_Date
]
```

On approve:

```
input.Status = "Approved";
sendmail
[
    from: zoho.adminuserid
    to: input.Employee_Email
    subject: "Your leave request is approved"
    message: "Dear " + input.Employee_Name + ", your leave has been approved."
]
```

Note: an Employee_Email field (Email type) must be added to the form for this script. Field names and the approval screens may look slightly different in your version of Zoho Creator.

Attach screenshot here - workflow / approval configuration

Attach screenshot here - Status updated and e-mail received

Test Results

Test	Action	Expected Result
1	Submit new leave request	Status Pending, manager gets mail
2	Manager approves	Status Approved, employee gets mail
3	Manager rejects	Status Rejected, employee gets mail

Results

An approval-based workflow was configured, and requests moved automatically from Pending to Approved or Rejected with e-mail notifications.

Conclusion

Workflow automation removes manual follow-up, speeds up decisions and keeps a clear record of every approval. Zoho Creator allows this with simple configuration and a few lines of Deluge.